

SUPERFLUOUS EXPRESSIONS

Superfluous means 'more than required'. When we use extra words to say something and these extra words are actually not needed, superfluous errors are committed. Some mistakes in English are committed because the student is ignorant about them and he writes whatever he hears around him. But what we speak is different from what we write.

Look at this sentence

- When will you return back from Delhi ?

Return means to go back to the original position, so the word 'back' is unnecessary in this sentence. The correct sentence would be - When will you return from Delhi?

What is slang ?

It is also important to know about the usage of slang words. They are those words which are not used in standard English. Rather, they are used by a specific group of people.

Eg- What is your good name? In standard English we don't say good name-We simply say-What is your name?

It is important for the students to know these superfluous expressions :-

Given below is a list of superfluous expressions

1. **A long period of time** – Use of 'time' is superfluous as a long period refers to the passage of time.
2. **All time record** – Record refers to the best or worst performance of all times. We do not need to use 'all time' with 'record'.
3. **Ask a question**- To ask means to pose a question
4. **ATM machine**-The full form of ATM is Automated Teller Machine.The use of machine with ATM is superfluous.
5. **Basic + Necessities/essentials/fundamentals**- Necessities/essentials/fundamentals are by their nature basic or elementary.
6. **Brief moment/summary**- A moment or summary is by definition brief.
7. **Circulate around**- Circulate means to move about freely through a closed system or area.
8. **Cut it out**- Cut it means to remove something so 'out' is unnecessary.
9. **Mutual agreement** - The situation in which people have the same opinion, or in which they approve of or accept is known as an agreement.The word 'mutual' is not needed.
10. **Respected Sir** –The word sir is used when someone is addressed to with respect. So respected is not needed.
11. **Close scrutiny**- Scrutiny itself means a close study.
12. **Past record** – With record and history, the word past should not be used.
13. **Collaborate/Join/merge/combine/fuse + Together** - 'Collaborate/Join/merge/combine/fuse' all these mean to put together.
14. **Past memories** – With memories, there is no need to use past.
15. **Same identical** – Identical means of the same or similar type. The word 'same' need not be used.
16. **Unexpected surprise** – Surprise means something that happens by chance. So unexpected will not be used.
17. **Basic fundamentals** - fundamental means forming an essential foundation or starting point. So, 'basic'

will not be used.

18. **Compete with each other** - To compete is to strive to gain or win something by establishing superiority over others.
19. **Regular pattern** - A pattern is the repeated or regular way in which something happens or is done. So, we can not use 'regular' and 'pattern' together.
20. **Regular tradition** - A tradition is a custom or belief that has existed for a long time. The word regular is not needed.
21. **Final conclusion** - Conclusion means the end or finish of an event. The word final is not needed.
22. **Final Destination** - Destination is the place to which someone is going or something is being sent. The word final is superfluous.
23. **Current trend** - Trend means something that is the general course or tendency. So current is unnecessary.
24. **Come across suddenly** - Come across means to meet someone by chance or to find something all of a sudden. The use of suddenly is superfluous.
25. **Comparatively better** - Better means something is more desirable. It is already in the comparative degree, so comparatively will not be used.
26. **Latest news** - News is noteworthy information, about recent events. So the use of the word "latest" is redundant.
27. **Cousin brother** - With cousin, brother or sister is not used.
28. **Three triplets** - This phrase becomes superfluous when we have a single set of three items and we are using the term 'three triplets' to refer to the three items.
29. **Exceed more than** - Exceed means to be greater in number or size than (a quantity, number, or other measurable thing). The use of "more than" is unnecessary.
30. **Different kinds** - "Kinds" refers to variety or types which are essentially different from each other.
31. **Kindly requested** - Request means to ask for something politely or formally. The word kindly is not needed.
32. **Requested to return back** - With 'return', we do not use the word 'back'.
33. **Empty space** - Space refers to a continuous area or expanse which is free available and unoccupied. It is essentially empty. We do not need to use 'empty' with it.
34. **Few in number** - Few refers to a small number. So we don't need the modifier "in Number."
35. **Absolutely certain /sure/ guaranteed** - The words 'certain, sure or guarantee' are absolute by nature.
36. **Foreign imports** - Imports are products that originate in a foreign country. The word foreign is superfluous.
37. **Despite of** - With despite, 'of' is not used.
38. **Repeat again** - Repeat means to do or say something one more time. So, again will not be used.
39. **Free gift** - A gift is given free of cost. Do not use 'free' with it.
40. **Blunder mistake** - A blunder means a big mistake. Do not use the word mistake with blunder.
41. **Reason because** - Because means as a result of. So the word reason will not be used.
42. **Close proximity** - Proximity means nearness in space, time, or relationship. So the use of 'close' is unnecessary.

43. **Supposing if** – Suppose means to think or assume that something is true or probable. Don't use 'if' with it.
44. **In case if** – 'If' and 'in case' are used independently to denote a condition. We can not use them together.
45. **Ask and inquire** - Inquire means to ask for information from someone. Don't use 'ask' with 'enquire'.
46. **Consensus of opinion** – Consensus is a general agreement. We do not need to use 'opinion' with it.
47. **Added bonus** - A bonus is an extra amount of money that is added to someone's pay. So the word 'added' is not needed.
48. **During the period of crisis/ During the period of drought/ During the period of flood/ During the period of famine /During the period of war-** In these expressions the usage of the word 'period' is superfluous. The correct expressions would be- During the crisis/ During the drought/ During the flood/ During the famine /During the war.
49. **Final outcome/ End result** - The word 'outcome' means the result or effect of an action or event .The word final is 'superfluous' here. Similarly, the use of 'end' is superfluous in the phrase 'end result'.
50. **Flee away** - Flee means to run away. So, the use of 'away' is superfluous with flee.

Some more superfluous expressions

There are some words which start with 're'. After some of them we don't have to add back or again. These words are as follows:-

- a) return, reimburse, retreat, recede, recall, recapitulate – **never use "back" after them.**
 b) reborn, rebuild, reiterate, recast, repeat, rewrite - **never use "again" after them.**

Practice Exercise

Directions :- In these questions, read each sentence to find out whether there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer, if there is no error the answer is (d). (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

Q.1. I do not care about the final outcome. I want to stand beside my friend in this hour of crisis.

- (a) I want to stand beside (b) the final outcome
 (c) I do not care about (d) my friend in this hour of crisis

Q.2. Supposing if the situation does not turn out to be in your favour, do we have a backup plan?

- (a) does not turn out to be (b) Supposing if the situation
 (c) do we have a back up plan. (d) in your favour

Q.3. By the consensus opinion of everybody we decided to cooperate with the police in the investigation

- (a) By the consensus opinion of (b) everybody we decided to
 (c) cooperate with the police (d) in the investigation

Q.4. The basic necessities include food, clothing, shelter and education

- (a) The basic necessities (b) include food, (c) clothing, shelter (d) and education

Q.5. The end result of the election will definitely be in favour of the Democrats.

- (a) will definitely be in (b) of the election (c) favour of the Democrats. (d) The end result

Q.6. He was shot directly on his chest from close proximity.

- (a) close proximity (b) chest from (c) directly on his (d) He was shot

Q.7. We can learn a lot of lessons from the past history but unfortunately our politicians are not interested in learning from history

- (a) can learn a lot of lessons (b) but unfortunately our politicians
 (c) interested in learning (d) from the past history

Q.8. Everybody likes to receive free gifts

- (a) receive free gifts (b) No error (c) likes to (d) Everybody

Q.9. Not listening to my parents during the crucial years of my college life was a blunder mistake that I committed.

- (a) during the crucial years of my college (b) was a blunder mistake
(c) that I committed (d) Not listening to my parents

Q.10. His close proximity to the chief minister helped him in getting many lucrative orders.

- (a) many lucrative orders. (b) helped him in getting
(c) to the chief minister (d) His close proximity

Q.11. I have two twins who are very similar in behaviour.

- (a) I have two twins very (b) who are very (c) No error (d) similar in behaviour

Q.12. The prime minister in his speech laid emphasis on cutting down of foreign imports.

- (a) of foreign imports (b) on cutting down (c) his speech laid emphasis (d) The prime minister in

Q.13. The child was slow in writing so he requested the teacher to repeat the question again

- (a) the teacher to repeat (b) in writing so he requested
(c) the question again (d) The child was slow

Q.14. He tried very hard but could not recall the phone number back.

- (a) No error (b) the phone number again
(c) hard but could not recall (d) He tried very

Q.15. Everybody is kindly requested to clear their dues by the end of the month.

- (a) Everybody is kindly (b) requested to clear their dues
(c) by the end of the month (d) No error

Q.16. I am feeling comparatively better after discussing the matter with you.

- (a) comparatively better (b) I am feeling (c) after discussing the (d) matter with you

Q.17. The reason why most of the parents feel uncomfortable staying with their children during old age is because they feel they are becoming a burden

- (a) No error (b) old age is because they feel they are becoming a burden
(c) staying with their children during (d) why most of the parents feel uncomfortable

Q.18. The lady instructed the gardener that all the empty space of her garden should be occupied by plants

- (a) by plants (b) her garden should be occupied
(c) that all the empty space of (d) The lady instructed the gardener

Q.19. I am absolutely certain that the result of the exam will arrive on Sunday.

- (a) I am absolutely certain (b) that the result
(c) of the exam will (d) arrive on Sunday.

Q.20. Despite of working very hard he failed to clear the third level of the exam

- (a) the third level of the exam (b) he failed to clear (c) Despite of (d) working very hard

Q.21. You are requested to return back all the money that you borrowed with interest.

- (a) You are requested to (b) the money that you
(c) borrowed with interest (d) return back all

Q.22. The child promised his teacher that he would not repeat the careless mistake again.

- (a) mistake again (b) repeat the careless (c) that he would not (d) child promised his teacher

Q.23. The reason because I am here is that I need to discuss an important issue with you.

- (a) an important issue with you (b) I need to discuss
(c) The reason because (d) I am here is that

Q.24. The victims were few in number and the police arrived on time so everybody's life was saved.

- (a) victims were few in number (b) on time so everybody's
(c) and the police arrived (d) life was saved.

Q.25. A long period of time has passed since I last met you for coffee.

- (a) for coffee (b) I met you last (c) has passed since (d) A long period of time

Q.26. It's the responsibility of the government to look after the basic necessities of the citizens.

- (a) No error (b) of the citizens
(c) to look after the basic necessities (d) the responsibility of the government

Q.27. The accountant is expected to do a close scrutiny of all the figures.

- (a) accountant is expected (b) to do a close scrutiny
(c) of all the figures (d) No error

Q.28. They have decided to collaborate together for this music album

- (a) music album (b) together for this (c) to collaborate (d) they have decided

Q.29. I received an unexpected surprise from my brother last night.

- (a) last night (b) from my brother (c) an unexpected surprise (d) I received

Q.30. Such cyclones are a regular pattern in this part of the world.

- (a) which is seen (b) Such cyclones are a regular pattern
(c) in this part of the world (d) No error

Q.31. The speech given by the Director was vaguely ambiguous as no one could understand what he was talking about.

- (a) what he was talking about. (b) The speech given by
(c) as no one could understand (d) the Director was vaguely ambiguous

Q.32. She whispered softly in his ear, sharing a secret that only they would know.

- (a) whispered softly (b) in his ear
(c) sharing a secret (d) they would know

Q.33. He nodded his head in agreement, acknowledging the wisdom of her words.

- (a) nodded his head (b) in agreement
(c) acknowledging the wisdom (d) her words

Q.34. They screamed loudly at the concert, caught up in the electrifying atmosphere.

- (a) screamed loudly (b) at the concert
(c) caught up in the electrifying (d) they

Q.35. The police were trying to erase the pre-recorded statement of the witness.

- (a) No error (b) to erase the pre-recorded
(c) statement of the witness. (d) The police were trying

Q.36. He set multiple alarms on his phone lest he should not oversleep and miss his flight.

- (a) and miss his flight (b) He set multiple alarms on his
(c) No error (d) phone lest he should not oversleep

Q.37. His annual income increased significantly over the course of a year.

- (a) No error (b) increased significantly over
(c) the course of a year (d) His annual income

Q.38. The new initiative is currently in the planning stages at the present time.

- (a) currently in the planning (b) No Error
(c) stages at the present time (d) The new initiative is

Q.39. Even after many rounds of talks Russia and Ukraine could not reach a mutual agreement on the issue of the border area.

- (a) Russia and Ukraine could not reach (b) the issue of the border area
(c) a mutual agreement on (d) Even after many rounds of talks

Q.40. The students have already taken the Tier-2 exam and the result is being awaited for.

- (a) is being awaited for (b) No Error
(c) the Tier-2 exam and the result (d) The students have already taken

Q.41. No matter how much it costs, the company will reimburse back all the expenses.

- (a) No matter how much it costs (b) all the expenses
(c) No error (d) the company will reimburse back

Q.42. One who is not able to face the ups and downs of life manfully is known as a coward man.

- (a) the ups and downs of life (b) manfully is known as a coward man

- (c) No error (d) One who is not able to face

Q.43. Ram's calculating skills are equally as good as yours.

- (a) are equally as good as (b) yours
(c) No error (d) Ram's calculating skills

Q.44. The magistrate warned the witness, "you can not retract back from your statement once it is recorded."

- (a) you can not retract back from (b) once it is recorded.
(c) The magistrate warned the witness (d) your statement

Q.45. He didn't mean to cause trouble, but on the contrary, he hoped to bring peace.

- (a) No error (b) but on the contrary
(c) he hoped to bring peace (d) He didn't mean to cause

Q.46. We cannot illustrate about the outcome of climate change in just a few days, such changes occur over decades or even centuries.

- (a) just a few days, such changes occur (b) We cannot illustrate about
(c) over decades or even centuries. (d) the outcome of climate change in

Q.47. The exam will be conducted at 9:00 A.M tomorrow morning.

- (a) No error (b) conducted at 9:00 A.M
(c) tomorrow morning (d) The exam will be

Q.48. Anwar, my cousin brother has been promoted to the position of regional manager.

- (a) the position of regional manager (b) has been promoted to
(c) No error (d) Anwar, my cousin brother

Q.49. Raghu left India with bag and baggage to earn money.

- (a) bag and baggage (b) No error
(c) to earn money (d) Raghu left India with

Q.50. The athlete had to withdraw back from the competition due to injury.

- (a) The athlete had (b) No error
(c) to withdraw from the (d) competition due to injury

Answers with Explanation :-

Sol.1.(b) Remove the word 'final' before 'outcome'.

Sol.2.(b) Remove the word if. 'If' and 'supposing' are not used together.

Sol.3.(a) Remove 'opinion'. The use of 'opinion' with 'consensus' is superfluous.

Sol.4.(a) Remove the word 'basic' before necessities.

Sol.5.(d) Remove the word 'end' before 'result'.

Sol.6.(a) 'Remove the word 'close'. Close proximity is superfluous.

Sol.7.(d) Remove the word 'past'. Use of 'past' with 'memories' is superfluous.

Sol.8.(a) Remove the word free as gifts are always free.

Sol.9.(b) Remove the word mistake. A blunder means a big mistake.

Sol.10.(d) Remove the word 'close'. Proximity means nearness or closeness.

Sol.11.(a) Remove the word two as twins means two children born together.

Sol.12.(a) Remove the word foreign as imports are the items that are brought from another country.

Sol.13.(c) Remove the word 'again' as repeat itself means to do or say something again.

Sol.14.(b) Remove the word 'back' as recall has been used.

Sol.15.(a) The word requested has been used, so we need to remove the word 'kindly'.

Sol.16.(a) Better is an adjective of comparative degree so the word 'comparatively' will be removed.

Sol.17.(b) Remove 'because' as we have already used the phrase 'the reason why' to describe the reason.

Sol.18.(c) Remove the word empty. 'Empty' can't be used with 'space'.

Sol.19.(a) Remove the word absolutely. 'Certain' itself gives absolute meaning.

Sol.20.(c) Remove 'of' after despite.

Sol.21.(d) Remove the word 'back'. We do not use the word 'back' with 'return'.

Sol.22.(a) Remove the word again as 'repeat' has already been used.

Sol.23.(c) Remove 'because'. We do not use 'because' and 'reason' together.

Sol.24.(a) Few itself means small in number, so we need to remove "in number" from the sentence.

Sol.25.(d) Remove 'of time' after 'a long period'.

Sol.26.(c) Remove the word 'basic'. Its use is superfluous with the word 'necessities'.

Sol.27.(b) The word 'scrutiny' means to closely examine. So, the word 'close' will be removed.

Sol.28.(b) With 'collaborate', there is no need to use 'together'.

Sol.29.(c) A surprise means an unexpected event. Remove the word 'unexpected'.

Sol.30.(b) Replace 'a regular pattern' with 'regular'. The use of 'regular' with 'pattern' is superfluous.

Sol.31.(d) Remove the word 'vaguely' as 'ambiguous' and 'vaguely' have the same meaning.

Sol.32.(a) Remove 'softly' as whispered means to speak very softly.

Sol.33.(a) 'Nodded' means to move your head in agreement. So remove 'his head'.

Sol.34.(a) As 'screamed' means to cry out loudly. So use of 'loudly' with screamed is superfluous.

Sol.35.(b) 'Pre' will be removed. Recording is something that is 'pre'.

Sol.36.(d) We do not use 'not' with lest.....should. So remove not.

Sol.37.(d) Remove the word 'annual', as 'over the course of a year' is mentioned in the sentence.

Sol.38.(c) Use of 'at the present time' with 'currently' is superfluous. So remove 'at the present time'.

Sol.39.(c) 'Mutual agreement' is a superfluous expression. So remove 'mutual'.

Sol.40.(a) we do not use 'for' with awaited. So remove 'for'.

Sol.41.(d) Remove the word 'back'. As 'reimburse' means to pay back to someone.

Sol.42.(b) Remove the word 'man'. 'Coward man' is a superfluous expression.

Sol.43.(a) 'as + positive degree + as' is used for comparison. So, 'equally' must be removed.

Sol.44.(a) 'back' should be omitted.

Sol.45.(b) Remove the word 'but'.

Sol.46.(b) Use of 'illustrate' with 'about' is superfluous. So remove 'about'.

Sol.47.(c) As A.M refers to morning, so remove the word 'morning'.

Sol.48.(d) Remove the word 'brother'. "Cousin brother" is a superfluous expression.

Sol.49.(a) 'Bag and Baggage' means with all his belongings. So, remove 'with'.

Sol.50.(c) "Withdraw back" is a superfluous expression. So remove 'back'.

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